



Cat's Eye
nebula

What's in a name?

Horsehead, Lagoon, Eagle and Cat's Eye... some of the best-known nebulae have popular names inspired by their shape.



Is that one red?

Some stars shine red, others shine yellow or bluish white. A star's colour depends on its temperature. Red stars are the coolest, while blue stars are the hottest.

In the same way, lava reveals its temperature through its colour. Here, the yellow lava is hotter than the red.



Our Sun is
a yellow
dwarf star.

What type of star?

Stars have different characteristics according to the amount of matter involved in their birth. They differ in colour, temperature, and brightness, and in the length of time they stay alive.

The life of a star

The Universe is home to lots of different types of star.



Red dwarfs are smaller than our Sun. They burn fuel slowly, so they live a long time.



Young solar systems Leftover material from a star's formation can turn into planets.



Blue giants are among the hottest stars, and live for less than 100 million years.



Supergiants are the rarest stars. They have short lives – under 50 million years.